

5. Microsoft Account Integration allows you to use your Microsoft account to log in to Windows. It's also used to sync files and settings.
6. Refresh and Reset of the OS helps reset the settings to defaults in case things go wrong. Since Windows 8 was designed to suit the mobile ecosystem as well, this feature has found its way onto the desktop. You may not need to do a complete reinstall anymore!
7. Connected Standby mode allows Windows 8 to use special power management features for your computer to continue receiving updates over the network while using the least power possible.
8. Snap or Snap apps, as we've already mentioned, allow you to look at desktop apps when using a Modern UI app and vice versa.
9. Storage Spaces allows Windows to use multiple disks for one single volume; it's similar to LVM on Linux.

Of these new features, Storage Spaces isn't supported on the RT edition.

The Remote Desktop feature on Windows 8 is limited to a client-only setting while Windows 8 Pro can act as both, client and server. Also, all editions of Windows 8 include the revamped Windows Explorer now known as 'File Explorer'; Windows Update, Updated Task Manager, Internet Explorer 10, Windows Store and an improved multi-monitor support are also included in all the editions.

Features such as BitLocker, EFS, Booting from VHD, Domain membership, Group Policy and Hyper-V are available only in Pro and Enterprise editions and are targeted at advanced users. Since these features are used mostly by enterprises, we've covered them in a later chapter dedicated to enterprise features available in Windows 8.

NOTE

The most confusing part about this new OS is with regards to the versions that are available. The PC user has it easy, just having to decide between a regular Windows 8 and a Pro version. The problem comes when you're choosing a tablet. The RT version of Windows, while it looks like a full-blown Windows 8 OS is more of a fully-featured Windows Phone 8 than a desktop OS. Few desktop apps are compatible with it and we'll talk about it in detail later.

Which edition should I buy?

Keeping in mind the differences between editions, we would recommend you to go for Windows 8 unless you're in need of enterprise class features.